

MIZORAM PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION

COMPETITIVE EXAMINATION FOR THE POST OF SERICULTURE EXTENSION OFFICER UNDER SERICULTURE DEPARTMENT (AUGUST-2025)

GENERAL ENGLISH

Time Allowed : 3 hours

FM : 100

Marks are indicated against each question.

1. Write a précis of the following passage and give a suitable title: **(14)**

Trees give shade for the benefit of others, and while they themselves stand in the sun and endure the scorching heat, they produce the fruit of which others profit. The character of good men is like that of trees. What is the use of this perishable body if no use is made of it for the benefit of mankind? Sandalwood, the more it is rubbed, the more scent does it yield. Sugarcane, the more it is peeled and cut up into pieces, the more juice does it produce. The men who are noble at heart do not lose their qualities even in losing their lives. What matters whether men praise them or not? What difference does it make whether they die at this moment or whether lives are prolonged? Happen what may, those who tread in the right path will not set foot in any other. Life itself is unprofitable to a man who does not live for others. To live for the mere sake of living one's life is to live the life of dog and crows. Those who lay down their lives for the sake of others will assuredly dwell for ever in a world of bliss.

2. Write a complaint to the Director of Sericulture Department, Mizoram regarding supply of defective goods from Hill's Company. **(10)**
3. Read the following Passage and choose the right answer to the questions given below: **(5×2=10)**

The major ground for rejecting the fusion of political and communal aspirations seems to be the physical dangers to which this exposes the citizens of a country unlike political appeals to class factors, political appeals to communal questions are much more concrete, precise and emotion charged since they involve intimate and personal sentiments. The language issue, for instance, can never be an abstract issue to any citizen in a country relative, say, to the issue of social welfare, poverty eradication, or expansion of educational opportunities.

Politicians in their quest for power can escalate such emotions to a frenzy of ill feeling among the communities. Moreover, members of communal groups and their neighbourhoods are easily identifiable and can become easy targets of attack. The norms of civilised governments cannot allow the rioting, looting and killing, which is a normal consequence of communalism which seeks power. Hence, in one way or other a lid is sought to be put on communal politics.

However, it would be well for political leaders, public administrators and researchers to recognise community based political aspirations for what they are rather than to merely condemn them with value loaded judgement. Clearly it is sufficient for civilised governments to reject communal politics on grounds of the danger to which it exposes the communities which constitute the nation. Efficient policy decision can be formulated only on the basis of a clear recognition of issues.

- (i) "Fusion of political and communal aspirations" implies:
- (a) confusing political and communal ambitions
 - (b) trying to gain political power through exploiting communal sentiments
 - (c) allowing political and communal ambitions to co-exist
- (ii) Which one of the following is an illustration of the class factor?
- (a) Communal tensions
 - (b) Anti-reservation movement
 - (c) Labour unrest
- (iii) Why do politicians feel interested in exploiting religion for serving **their** political ends?
- (a) Because they are biased against other religions
 - (b) Because politicians can serve their interest better under the garb of constitutional guarantee for religious freedom
 - (c) Because politicians find it easier to gain the sympathy of their coreligionists
- (iv) Why do politicians raise communal feelings to frenzy?
- (a) Because they have no respect for the norms of a civilised government
 - (b) Because they want to exploit communal feelings for gaining more power
 - (c) Because Indian politics is by and large based on the division of the population on communal lines
- (v) What solution does the author offer for tackling communal politics?
- (a) To condemn it as anti-national and anti-people
 - (b) To identify political aspirations behind communal politics and tackle them for what they are
 - (c) To concede religious demands to diffuse the situation

4. Fill in the blanks with the appropriate preposition:

(10×1=10)

- (a) She has been waiting here _____ a long time.
- (b) There is no exception _____ this rule.
- (c) The cat is hiding _____ the bed.
- (d) We will meet _____ the library after school.
- (e) She poured the milk _____ the glass.
- (f) The books are scattered _____ the room.
- (g) I have known him _____ we were teenagers.
- (h) She peered _____ the telescope.
- (i) The dog jumped _____ the fence.
- (j) After all hard work has come to tell _____ your health.

5. Fill in the blanks with the correct form of verb given in the brackets:

(10×1=10)

- (a) He _____ there as if he were dead. (lie)
- (b) You _____ out my orders. (carry)
- (c) At this moment I _____ an exercise on tenses. (do)
- (d) Every morning, John _____ a jog in the park. (take)
- (e) Mary _____ a novel now. (read)
- (f) I _____ asleep in the middle of his boring story. (fall)
- (g) He told me that he _____ me if he could. (help)
- (h) I _____ him quite well when I was young. (know)

- (i) Where _____ you this morning? (be)
- (j) It started to rain while we _____ tennis. (play)

6. Rewrite the following sentences as directed: (10×2=20)

- (a) Millions of people study English throughout the world. (**Change into passive sentence**)
- (b) He studied medicine for six years. He could not get a medical degree. (**Combine into a Single Sentence with the use of 'but'**)
- (c) If you work hard, you will pass. (**Pick out the Adverb Clause stating its kind and the word it modifies**)
- (d) He confessed his guilt. (**Change into Complex Sentence**)
- (e) Pay heed to what your officers say. (**Change into Simple Sentence**)
- (f) Rama said, 'I am very busy now'. (**Change into Indirect Speech**)
- (g) Man is a wonderful piece of work. (**Change into Exclamatory Sentence**)
- (h) He said that he was unwell. (**Change into Direct Speech**)
- (i) I shall see him sometimes. (**Change into an Interrogatory Sentence**)
- (j) John would finish his work. He would not leave the place otherwise. (**Combine the two sentences using 'until'**)

7. The following sentences consist of a word or phrase which is written in italics followed by a group of words. Select the word nearest in meaning to the italicised word or phrase: (5×1=5)

- (i) People of different *persuasions* have met on the same platform.
 - (a) personalities
 - (b) convictions
 - (c) qualifications
- (ii) The new government decided to *rescind* most of the decisions of its predecessor.
 - (a) modify
 - (b) impose
 - (c) repeal
- (iii) He likes his friend inspite of his little *frailties*.
 - (a) timidity
 - (b) weakness
 - (c) oddities
- (iv) She has an *insatiable* love for music.
 - (a) voracious
 - (b) vociferous
 - (c) unchanging
- (v) The atmosphere in the college is quite *pernicious* these days.
 - (a) amiable
 - (b) harmful
 - (c) dangerous

8. The following sentences consist of a word which is written in italics followed by a group of words. Select the word which is closest to the opposite in meaning of the italicised word or phrase: (5×1=5)

- (i) The decision was *delayed* because of him.
 - (a) advanced
 - (b) expedited
 - (c) triggered
- (ii) Mary was in a *dejected* mood.
 - (a) jubilant
 - (b) apathetic
 - (c) irritable

- (iii) I liked the poem for its *literal* meaning.
(a) fictitious (b) deep
(c) figurative
- (iv) She handled the machines with *deft* fingers.
(a) clumsy (b) delicate
(c) sturdy
- (v) His *urbane* attitude won him many friends.
(a) rude (b) violent
(c) casual

9. Select the One-Word Substitute for the following:

(5×2=10)

- (i) A person with a highly developed sense of beauty
(a) Gigolo (b) Fastidious
(c) Aesthete
- (ii) One who sneers at the aims and beliefs of his fellowmen
(a) Cynic (b) Altruist
(c) Misanthrope
- (iii) Prejudice against people from other countries
(a) Nyctophobia (b) Agoraphobi
(c) Xenophobia
- (iv) One who likes to spend time with others
(a) sleeping partner (b) comrade
(c) extrovert
- (v) The study and science of speech sounds
(a) phonetics (b) dietetics
(c) linguistics

10. Make sentences with *any 3 (three)* of the following Idioms & Phrases to bring out their meanings:

(3×2=6)

- (a) A Herculean task (b) To play fast and loose
(c) Hang together (d) Curtain lecture
(e) To speak volumes for (f) Above board

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